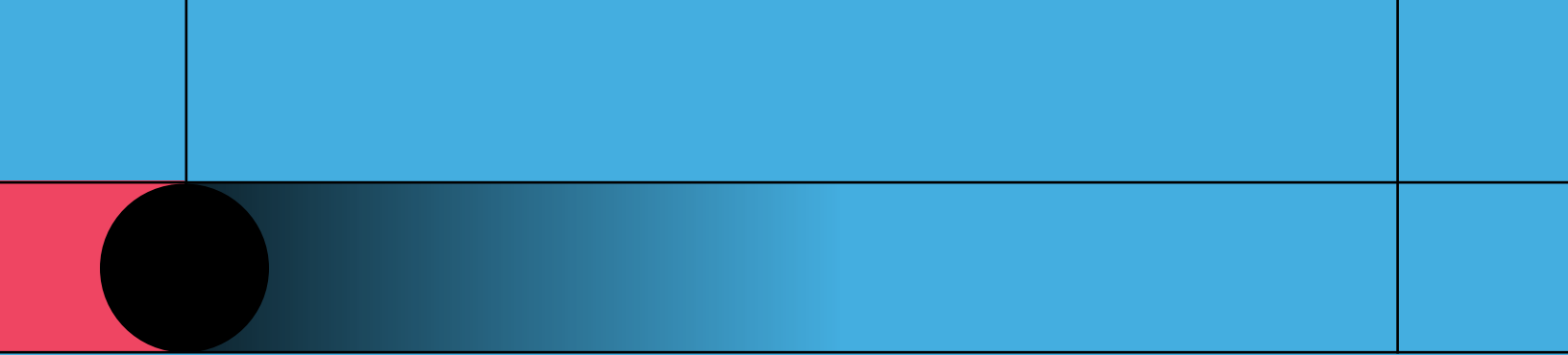




THE INCLUSIVE TEAM BUILDER'S PLAYBOOK

BUILDING INCLUSIVE TEAMS

Use this playbook to learn techniques for leading an inclusive team. Regardless of your organization's size, developing these tools and strategies for being more empathetic, resolving conflict, addressing harm, and fostering a sense of belonging will help you become a more successful leader.

MasterClass at Work



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LEADING A DIVERSE TEAM

Inclusion is a journey, not a destination

A diverse team not only helps support equitable access but also can have a positive impact on your business' bottom line. Its success depends on a leader's ability to create and sustain an inclusive culture, defined by a sense of belonging and psychological safety among all group members.

The ongoing work of building and maintaining an inclusive team revolves around four key activities:

1. Ensuring diverse representation

Whether you're building a totally new team or hiring a new member, it's important to consider representation. Ask yourself: Who are the people on my team and do they collectively represent diverse perspectives, backgrounds, and experiences? Avoid reducing an individual to a single dimension of their personhood, such as race. Instead, think about "intersectionality" or the many different attributes a person possesses that shape their identity and their point of view (e.g., race + gender + age).

2. Seeking input

Every time you onboard someone new to your team, there's an opportunity for you as a leader to learn about how this person likes to work, how they like to collaborate with others, and the kinds of support they need to thrive. You should also make a point to regularly check in with longtime employees. Keep a finger

on the pulse of your team, find out what challenges folks are experiencing, and encourage feedback on ways to improve processes and systems so that you can be more responsive to the needs of all team members.

3. Establishing clear processes and communication

People on your team need to know when and how they should speak up when a situation arises. If they are fearful about communicating a challenge or unsure about the protocols in place for flagging an issue, problems are likely to fester and result in further division, isolation, and hostility. A leader is responsible for establishing communication processes that are transparent and easy to access, ensuring team members understand those processes, and keeping track of any issues that are reported to confirm they have been addressed and resolved.

4. Being consistent

As a leader, your team will look to you to set the tone for an inclusive culture. That means modeling your team's values as well as holding others accountable for doing the same. When anyone fails to do so, address these incidents quickly and consistently.

PLAYBOOK EXERCISE:

How Do You Lay the Foundation for an Inclusive Team?

YOUR GOAL: Identify areas of inclusive leadership that you want to improve

READ THE FOLLOWING STATEMENTS AND CHOOSE THE RESPONSE THAT BEST REFLECTS YOUR CURRENT BEHAVIOR AND PRACTICES.

Rate yourself on the five-point scale below, with one being “not at all” and five being “very much so.”

I value building a team that is composed of individuals with diverse perspectives and backgrounds.

Not At All ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Much So

I feel comfortable seeking out and listening to diverse perspectives and opinions within my team.

Not At All ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Much So

I feel confident that I can have open and respectful communication with members of my team, regardless of their background or position.

Not At All ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Much So

I feel confident in my ability to mitigate the influence of bias on my decision-making and interactions with others.

Not At All ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Much So

I value curiosity and open-mindedness when it comes to learning about cultures different from my own.

Not At All ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Much So

I feel confident in my ability to lead collaboration within a diverse team.

Not At All ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Much So

I feel confident in my ability to intervene promptly and effectively when I witness biased behavior or discriminatory practices within my team.

Not At All ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Much So

I feel confident that if an issue were to arise among members of my team, there are processes in place to resolve the issue quickly and effectively.

Not At All ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Much So

I feel comfortable having my ideas and perspectives challenged by members of my team.

Not At All ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Much So

I feel comfortable leading difficult conversations with my entire team on issues of diversity, equity, and inclusion.

Not At All ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Much So

Based on your responses above, what is an area of inclusive leadership that you want to improve?

DEVELOPING SELF-AWARENESS THROUGH REFLECTION

Inclusive leadership begins by turning inward

We can't change our past and our upbringing. But we can reflect on how those experiences have shaped our behavior and thinking.

Know your personal data

Our experiences are the data we draw upon when making a decision to behave or act in a certain way. Whether it's the tone of voice we choose when addressing a colleague or deciding whom to hire among three candidates, our memories both consciously and unconsciously influence our decisions.

Record and reflect

To better appreciate how your experiences influence your actions, try analyzing an interaction or decision you want to better understand:

- Break down all of the steps that went into that decision or interaction, including details about the person or the context around the decision as well as the outcome.
- Think about related experiences from your past that may have influenced how you approached that interaction or decision point.
- Consider alternative approaches that could have resulted in a different outcome.

As an example, imagine you recently had a conversation with a direct report about their performance issues, and you chose to take a “tough love” approach with them to push them to improve. Your goal was for your conversation to motivate your report and make them committed to improvement, as had happened after your own boss had shown you tough love in a similar situation. The outcome of the conversation, however, was the opposite: The report became withdrawn and disengaged. In reflecting upon this conversation and what you could have done differently to arrive at a better outcome, you might ask yourself:

- Was a tough love approach right for this specific person at this specific time?
- How could I have shown more love and less toughness?
- What about my own experiences shaped how and why I chose a tough love approach?

Remember: Empathy and care for others starts with a deep understanding of ourselves.

PLAYBOOK EXERCISE:

How Do You Use Reflective Practice to Develop Self-Awareness?

YOUR GOAL: Complete two reflective-thinking exercises to help you develop tools for self-awareness

EXERCISE 1:**Define the attributes of your ideal manager**

Think about the traits and qualities of a manager that you would most want to work for:

ATTRIBUTE 1

ATTRIBUTE 2

ATTRIBUTE 3

PERSPECTIVE SWITCH:**Reflect on the attributes you listed**

What personal experiences and worldviews helped inform your vision of the ideal manager? How might someone with a different perspective or from a different culture respond to those attributes?

EXERCISE 2:**Break down a situation using reflective thinking**

Think about a recent interaction you had at work where the outcome of that interaction didn't achieve the results you were looking for. Work through the steps below to reflect on that interaction.

Describe the person you had the interaction with, why you had the interaction, and what the goals of the interaction were.

Break down each step of the interaction, from what prompted the interaction through the outcome of the interaction.

Take a step back and think about the decisions you made and behaviors you displayed during that interaction. Describe how your experiences or biases may have influenced your behavior in that moment.

Given the outcome, describe what you might have done differently to arrive at a better outcome for that interaction.

CONNECTING THROUGH EMPATHY AND STORYTELLING

Can you really walk a mile in someone else's shoes?

It might not always be possible or even healthy to actually take on the pain or challenges experienced by someone else. But you can still demonstrate care and concern for that person, and work with them to help address any issues they may face.

Understand empathy

Whereas sympathy is more of a passive observation of someone else's circumstances, empathy is the active process of imagining what that specific person might be feeling and experiencing.

Follow the new Golden Rule

The Golden Rule of treating others as you would want to be treated makes one problematic assumption related to em-

pathy: that we all want to be treated the same. But how you want to be treated may be a product of your upbringing, your culture, and your preferences, and that may have little resemblance to how someone else might want to be treated under the same circumstances. So, instead of treating others how you'd want to be treated, treat them how *they* want to be treated.

Be curious and ask questions

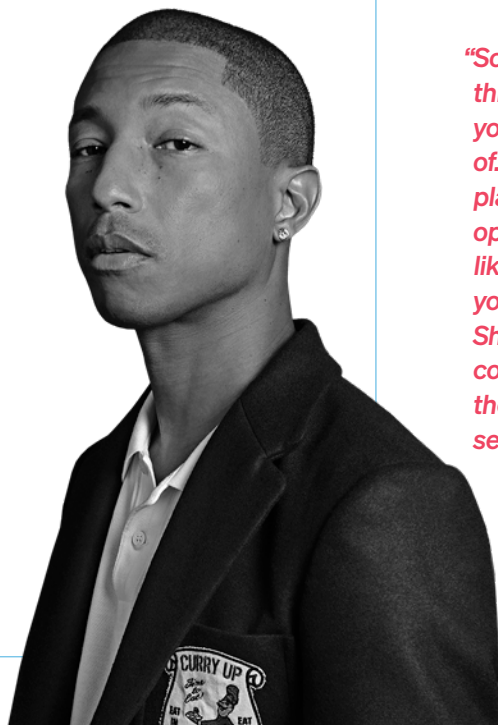
Asking questions and being curious about another person's situation can help you empathize with them and make them feel heard and acknowledged. Even if you think you understand what they may be going through because you've experienced something similar in your life, remember that every situation and every challenge is unique. Focus first on asking questions and learning about the particulars of their position before offering your own perspective.

Connect through stories

When we hear a story, we step outside ourselves and into the world of the narrative, which can help us better imagine and empathize with another person's circumstances. Encourage story sharing as a way to foster empathy and create connection around shared experiences and feelings.

"Sometimes selfishness is just like a... thing that you don't even realize that you participate in and that you're a part of. It's a slumber. Before you get to a place of empathy, a person has to be open or curious about the concept. It's like waking up. There's a moment when you absolutely know—you're like, 'I'm up.' Shedding your ego starts when you start considering other people and the role they play in your life, to go from selfish to selfless. And that's a lot of unpacking."

— PHARRELL WILLIAMS
MUSICIAN AND PRODUCER
[LINK TO LESSON](#)



PLAYBOOK EXERCISE:

How Do You Practice Empathy?

YOUR GOAL: Develop tools and techniques to become a more empathetic leader

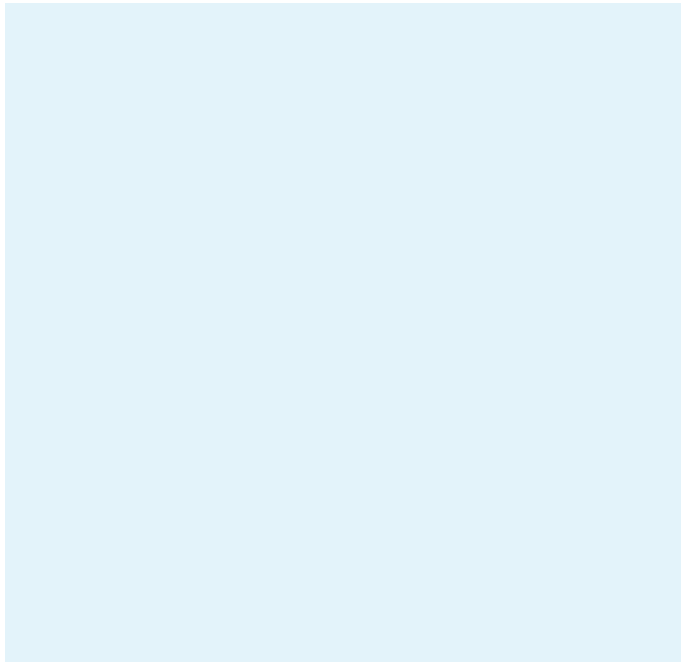
EMPATHY MAPS

An Empathy Map is a tool to help you better understand a situation from someone else's perspective. It contains six prompts for you to fill out:

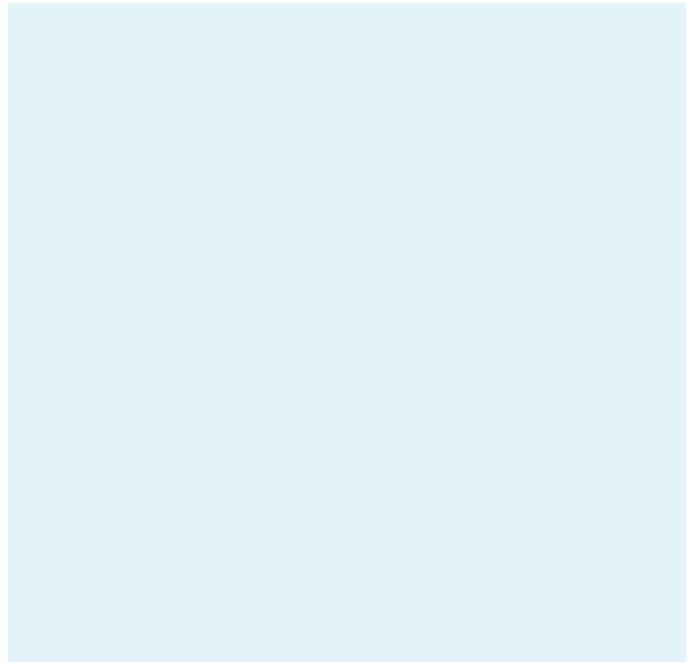
Describe who the person is and what makes them tick.

Describe what they do. What kinds of behaviors do they exhibit?

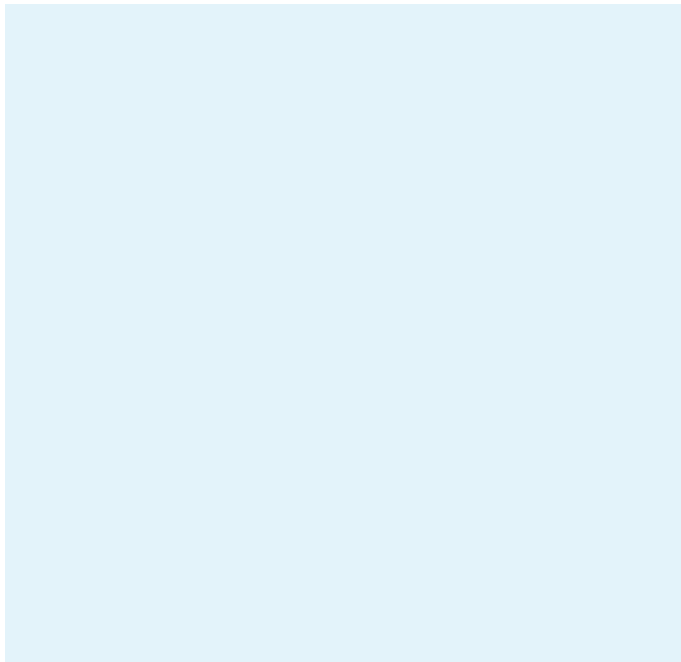
Describe their goals, needs, and pains.



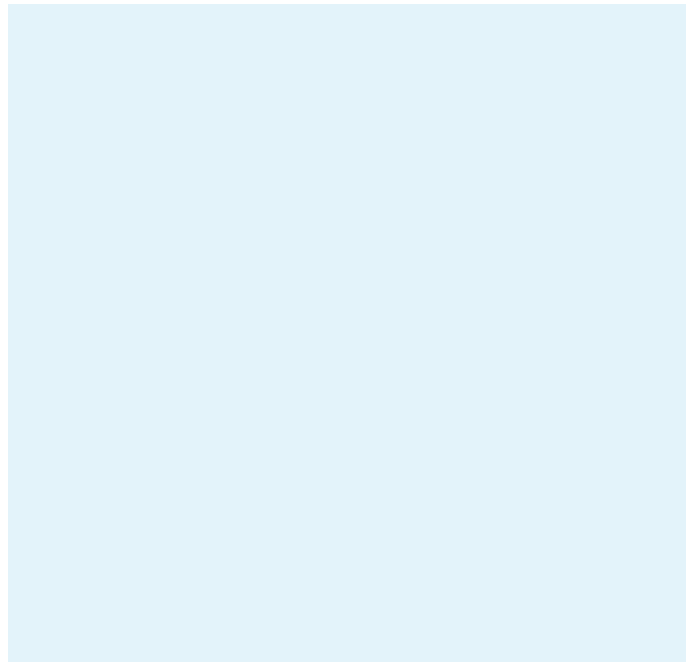
Describe what they feel. What kinds of emotions do you imagine they are experiencing?



Describe what they say. What do they verbalize to you or others?



Describe what they think. What kinds of concerns or worries do you imagine they are thinking about?



OBJECTIVE: Think about a person on your team or a person with whom you collaborate closely. Focus on a situation or exchange where there was some conflict, disagreement, or a general lack of clear communication.

Fill out the Empathy Map so that you can be more effective at communicating with this person.

Who is it and what do you know about them?

What do they say?

What do they do?

What do they feel?

What do they think?

What are their goals and needs?

UNDERSTANDING CONFLICT AND ADDRESSING HARM

Apply the right techniques based on the needs of the situation

If a conflict arises on your team, it's important to look below the surface to find out the root cause, which will better equip you to find the appropriate resolution. In most cases, the underlying issue concerns one of these three dynamics:

1. Power and priorities

These conflicts emerge when someone feels like they're not being prioritized. They may also experience feelings of powerlessness, or irrelevance, as if they're less important than other members of the team.

2. Closeness and connection

These conflicts result when two people don't trust each other, have a lack of meaningful connection, and/or feel that they can't count on one another.

3. Respect and recognition

These conflicts happen when one person doesn't feel valued, respected, or acknowledged by the other person.

"If you let that bias sit, if you don't disrupt the bias in the moment, then you are unintentionally reflecting and reinforcing it. It's going to keep happening, it's going to keep hurting people, so work on finding the words to address it."

KIM SCOTT
AUTHOR AND CONSULTANT
[LINK TO LESSON](#)

ADDRESSING HARM

When one person on your team either intentionally or unintentionally harms someone else in the group, it's important as a leader to understand how to deal with it so that the incident doesn't become a pattern of behavior. When you address harmful situations, there are three keys you should keep in mind:

1. Understand the type of harm caused

Did it stem from unconscious bias, a conscious prejudice, or intentional, malicious bullying?

2. Address the harm publicly and immediately

By addressing the harm publicly, you make it clear that such behavior won't be tolerated and that the team needs to be collectively committed to maintaining a healthy work environment.

3. Equip your team with a set of tools and a shared vocabulary

A commonly understood set of phrases or terms and a clear communication process can help people feel more confident and willing to call out harmful behaviors and find common ground with others to address any issues.



PLAYBOOK EXERCISE:

How Do You Resolve Conflict and Harm?

YOUR GOAL: Use the tools and techniques you've learned to resolve conflict and address harm

CHOOSE THE RIGHT STATEMENT BASED ON THE TYPE OF HARM

In the Understanding Conflict and Addressing Harm video (Chapter 4), Kim Scott explains three types of statements to address harm: “I” statements, “It” statements, and “You” statements. For each scenario, select the appropriate statement type to craft language you would use to call out the harm. If you're unsure, go back and watch the video.

SCENARIO: You've witnessed several occasions where a colleague makes belittling comments to a coworker, and while the victim of these comments hasn't spoken up yet, it is clear that they are bothered by them.

Craft a statement to address the situation using the correct statement type and describe what processes or protocols you would put in place for future meetings to prevent this behavior and improve overall communication.

SCENARIO: A man on your team jokes about women being more emotional and needing more support than men. He thinks he is being funny but he has made other stereotypes about women at work.

Craft a statement to address the situation using the correct statement type and describe what processes or protocols you would put in place for future meetings to prevent this behavior and improve overall communication.

SCENARIO: You've observed that for collaborative projects, a colleague from an underrepresented group hasn't gotten the same leadership opportunities as other members of the team, and is often relegated to working on more menial tasks. Other members of the team have not made an effort to provide their colleague with opportunities to showcase that colleague's talent and abilities.

Craft a statement to address the situation using the correct statement type and describe what processes or protocols you would put in place for future meetings to prevent this behavior and improve overall communication.

SCENARIO: In meetings, a man on your team is constantly interrupting and talking over a woman on the team. It's clear that this is upsetting her, but she hasn't spoken up about it, nor has anyone else on the team. The behavior seems to be getting worse, and as a leader, you're starting to get concerned that others are going to mimic the behavior. How might you address this situation?

Craft a statement to address the situation using the correct statement type and describe what processes or protocols you would put in place for future meetings to prevent this behavior and improve overall communication.

EMPOWER OTHERS THROUGH ALLYSHIP AND ADVOCACY

Be a participant, not a spectator

If members of your team have been harmed or feel like they don't belong, empathy without action won't improve their circumstances. As a leader, strive to be an ally and an advocate who's actively engaged in making tangible improvements to equity and access.

WHAT'S AN ALLY?

Allies contribute to a more inclusive workplace by actively supporting people from underrepresented groups. That support may be in the form of speaking up when you observe bias, prejudice, or bullying, as well as advocating for processes and policies that support more equitable access.

“Pity goes hand in hand with spectatorship. Compassion goes hand in hand with participation, with intervention, with caring enough and being concerned enough to want to change somebody's situation....Compassion is a particular form of love. And it's always, like any form of love, a kind of death, because there's no compassion without some killing of one's own narcissism, without murdering one's own egoism.”

— CORNEL WEST
PHILOSOPHER & ACTIVIST
[LINK TO LESSON](#)

INSPIRE CHANGE IN OTHERS

As a leader, you want members of your team to adopt an inclusive mindset and behaviors, and for each individual to contribute to the collective sense of belonging. Two ways to inspire change are:

1. Be an agitator, not an irritator

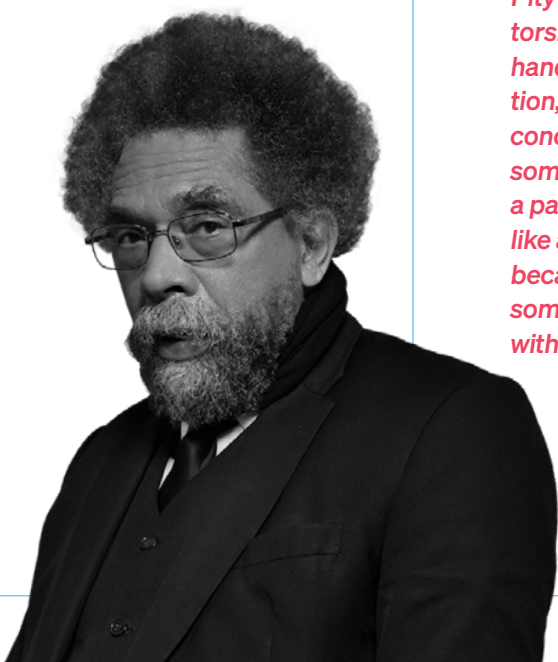
Irritators try to control and strong-arm others into changing their behavior, which hurts the person's sense of autonomy and ultimately their willingness to adapt. Agitators, on the other hand, create some discomfort but primarily engage in asking questions and listening to help motivate someone to make a change on their own.

2. Use storytelling

Unlike a list of facts or cold statistics, stories trigger empathy through a sense of connection that can inspire a shared sense of responsibility and a motivation to act.

EMBRACE THE PROCESS

Becoming an ally and an advocate requires a skillset that you develop over time. Don't be afraid to speak up even if you're not sure you're following the right process, but be willing to learn from your missteps. Approach each interaction with fresh eyes and open ears.



PLAYBOOK EXERCISE:

How Do You Foster a Greater Sense of Belonging?

YOUR GOAL: Design a team activity that helps create a greater sense of connection and community

OBJECTIVE: In “Communicating with Empathy and Care” (Chapter 3), you learned about the power of the Talking Circle as a way to bring people together to share stories, make decisions, build connections, and empower all members of your group to contribute. Think about a team meeting that you lead. How might you structure a conversation focused on sharing stories in order to build a sense of connection and foster belonging among members of your team? Complete the plan for facilitating a Talking Circle meeting.

What are the goals of the meeting?

Get specific about what you want people to get out of the conversation. You might think about an outcome, like coauthoring a set of team values focused on inclusion.

What kinds of stories do you want people to share?

Come up with a prompt that people will use to frame their story. For example, “Think about a time when...”

How will you create a safe space for sharing stories?

Detail the strategies you will use to make sure people feel comfortable opening up and having dialogues.

How will you ensure everyone has an equal voice during the meeting?

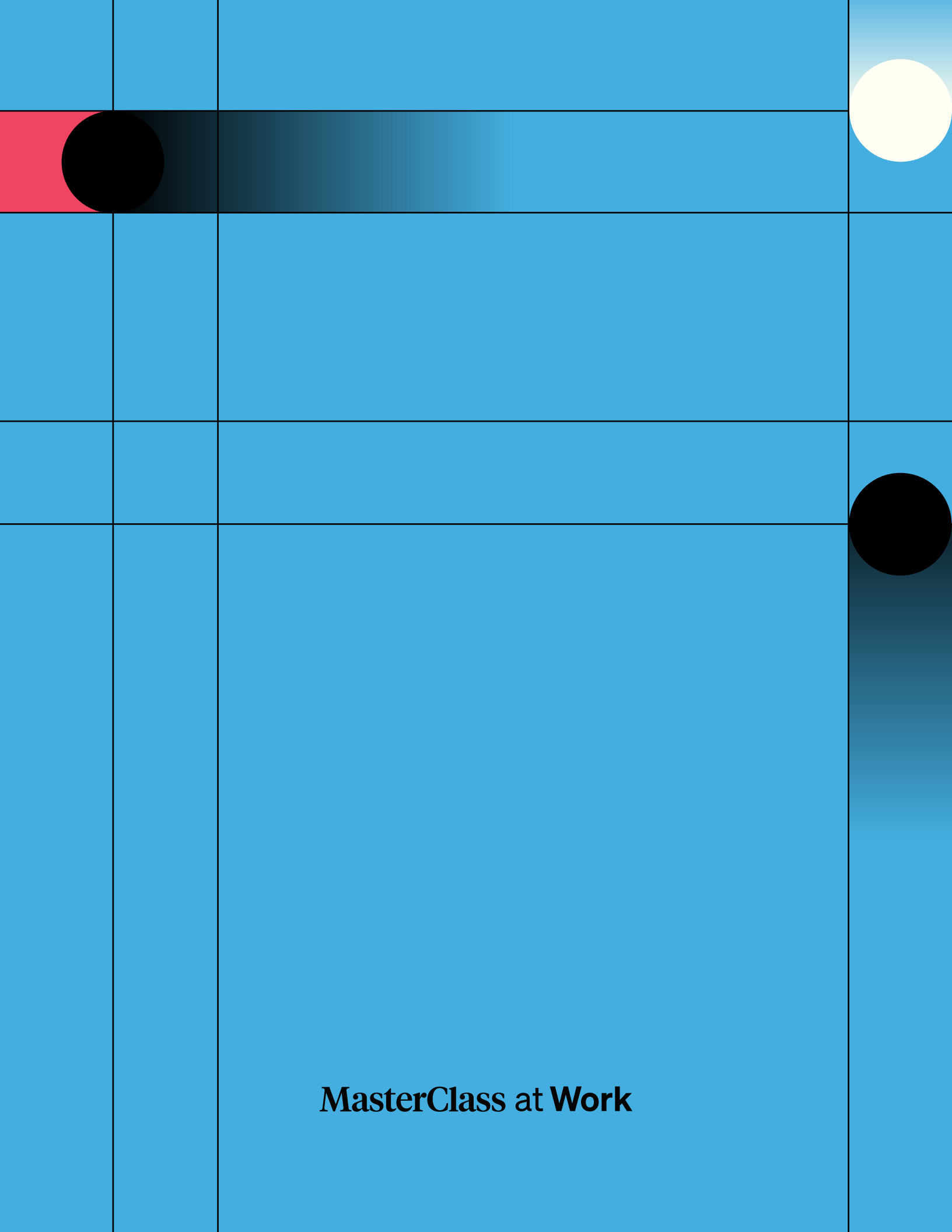
Detail the strategies you will use to make sure everyone has an opportunity to contribute to the conversation and feel acknowledged.

How will you handle any conflict or harm that might occur during the meeting?

Describe the process and tools you will use if someone violates your team standards.

What kinds of actions do you want people to take as a result of the meeting?

Think back to your goal or outcome and describe the actions people will take after the meeting. This might be implementing a new process for calling out bias or a new way of working together that fosters a greater sense of inclusion.



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